swapo

a HPY initiative

Website & App Playbook v5

Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange. India's first exchange marketplace from God's Own Country. v5 adds accounts (mobile, Google, Apple), Aadhaar-optional ID checks and trust 50, the 1,000-coin welcome bonus, auctions watched from 18 and bid on from 23, Swap Exclusive, reels, Discover, Swap Green, the new logo, and the backend with its Control Center.



Purpose
Hand-off for design, development & content

Supersedes
Playbook v4

Made with ♥ in Kochi
Swap is a HPY initiative

Date
October 2026

READ ME FIRST

How to use this document

Everything in the original strategy has been reviewed, tightened and reorganised so a designer, developer or copywriter can build directly from it. Copy inside the boxed "copy specs" is final, publishable text.

Legend

Marker	Meaning
NEW IN V5	Added in v5: features built since v4.
NEW IN V4	Added in v4: features built into the app and website since v3.
NEW	Not in v1. Added to close a gap.
CHANGED	Rewritten or restructured from v1.
CUT	Removed or merged elsewhere, with the reason given.
COMING SOON	A future feature. Present it as upcoming, never as live.
BUILD NOTE	Instructions for designers and developers. Not shown to visitors.
CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH	A claim or policy that may only be published once it is true or has been decided.
`{curly braces}`	Dynamic values filled in by the product, e.g. `{city}`, `{firstName}`.

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WHAT'S NEW IN V5

- **Accounts:** sign up with a username and a verified mobile number, then log in with a mobile code, Google, Apple, or username and password. Members can deactivate their account, or delete it with a 30-day grace period (Part 23).
- **Trust and welcome bonus:** trust starts at 50 with phone, email and ID verified. Aadhaar is one optional way to verify ID. A fully completed profile earns 1,000 Swap Coins once (Part 24).
- **New auction ages:** auctions can be seen from 18; bidding, buying and selling start at 23. Teens (15–17) no longer see auctions (Part 15).
- **Swap Exclusive:** one-of-one pieces auctioned by verified brands, with certificate numbers and verified bidders (Part 25).
- **Discover and reels:** Pinterest-style pins and boards, plus a full-screen reel feed for products and live auctions (Part 26). Social add-ons are in Part 27.
- **Swap Green:** one tree per completed swap, plus meals and a clean-up drive every 10,000 swaps (Part 28).
- **New identity:** the new logo, Plus Jakarta Sans everywhere, and line icons instead of emojis (Part 29).
- **Backend:** a Node.js API and a Control Center for staff, covering moderation, verification, settings and an audit log (Part 30).

NEW DECISION FOR THE FOUNDERS

Name: the new logo reads **"swapo"**, but the product, tagline and this playbook say **"Swap"**. Choose one before launch, and run the trademark search on that name.

WHAT'S NEW IN V4

- **Name and owner:** the brand is **Swap**, a HPY initiative. HPY is owned by Hiranya Mohandas. Swap is aligned with Sreejith Maheswar and Sankar R. Ownership is shown on the website only (Part 15).
- **Tagline restored:** "Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange." with the subline "India's first exchange marketplace from God's Own Country." and "Made with ❤ in Kochi".
- **Two editions from one build:** the app, and a LinkedIn-style website that adds the Ads Manager and the About/ownership page (Part 15).
- **Three plans:** Free, Pro ₹149 and Pro Plus ₹399 (Part 16).
- **Age rules:** 15+ can sign up. Paid plans, draws and the creator studio are 18+. *Updated in v5: auctions are seen from 18 and bid on from 23.*
- **Swap Coins and Women's Circle:** 100 coins per 5-star swap, usable in deals from 1,000, and 150 per swap between two verified Circle members (Part 17).
- **Pro Plus studio and calls:** auctions, free lucky draws, giveaways, challenges, mystery boxes, 2-minute videos, and voice and video calls (Part 18).
- **Community and ads:** events, groups, the Bike & Car category and the Swap Ads platform (Parts 20–21).
- **Futuristic look:** neon cyan and violet on deep space and 4-second motion profiles (Part 22). *Updated in v5: Plus Jakarta Sans replaces Orbitron and Manrope.*

FOUR DECISIONS THE FOUNDERS MUST MAKE

1. **Launch mode:** working marketplace on day one, or a waitlist site first? v1 left this open. This playbook gives copy for **both** (Part 03), so the choice doesn't hold up design.
2. **Cash in swaps:** can members add money to balance an uneven swap? **Decided in v4: no cash. Use Swap Coins instead** (Part 17). Money appears only in Pro auctions, inside escrow.
3. **Minimum age: Decided in v4: 15+ can join**, with auctions, paid plans, draws and the creator studio for 18+ only. India's DPDP Act 2023 still requires verifiable parental consent for every account under 18, and no tracking or targeted ads for them. See Part 15.
4. **Auctions at launch, or later?** Auctions need a licensed payment partner, escrow, GST set-up and a team to verify items. **Recommended:** launch swapping first, and open Pro auctions in phase 2 once payments and verification are ready.

PART 01

Analysis of v1

v1 is a strong foundation. The positioning is right, the phased roadmap is sensible and the tone is friendly. But it breaks several of its own rules, and it isn't yet ready to build from.

9/10	8/10	5/10	5/10	4/10
Positioning & concept clarity	Phased scope (products first)	Message & CTA consistency	Copy concision (mobile-readiness)	Build-readiness (SEO, legal, states)

What v1 gets right (kept)

- **Positioning:** v1's "Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange." is clear, memorable and sets Swap apart from OLX-style resale.
- **Products first, skills later:** this avoids promising features that don't exist yet.
- **The Have / Want idea:** the best product insight in the document. In v2 it is the centre of the experience.
- **Honest disclaimers:** examples are labelled as illustrative, and estimated values aren't guaranteed.
- **Abundance framing:** the brand is about resourcefulness, not financial hardship.

Issues found, and how v2 fixes them

#	Issue in v1	Fix in v2
1	**Too many slogans.** v1 says "avoid competing slogans", then uses 10+ ("List It. Match It. Exchange It.", "Your Stuff. Your Value…", "More Value. More Possibilities. Less Waste." and others).	A strict three-line hierarchy: tagline, promise and action line. Each has a defined job, and the rest are retired (Part 02).
2	**Inconsistent CTAs.** 15+ variants for the same action: "Start Exchanging", "List Something Now", "Create Your First Listing", "List a Product", "Start Your Exchange Journey"…	One CTA system. **List an Item** (primary) and **Explore Exchanges** (secondary) are used everywhere.
3	**The homepage contradicts itself.** Part 3 has 12 sections, but Part 8 recommends a 7–screen journey and warns against a "long article".	Homepage cut to **8 sections**, with real listings in screen 2 as v1's own UX section advises.
4	**Wordy copy.** The hero has 5 paragraphs. Filler words repeat: "discover" ×32, "opportunities" ×25, "possibilities" ×14, "eligible" ×6.	Hero body cut to one sentence. Word-use limits added to the voice guide. Copy is about 40% shorter overall.
5	**Launch mode unresolved.** The closing question (live vs. coming-soon) blocks every CTA decision.	Both modes written, with a swap table (Part 03).

6	**SEO mismatch.** The homepage targets “barter marketplace India”, but the word “barter” never appears in its copy. Several pages have no meta description, and none has a defined H1.	A full table of title, meta and H1 for every page. Keywords placed in the copy. Schema and technical SEO added (Part 11).
7	**Broken colour codes and accessibility failures.** Hex codes are split across lines (“#19B86 A”). Green on white is 2.6:1, lime on white is 1.1:1 and grey text is 3.8:1, all below the WCAG AA minimum of 4.5:1.	Codes corrected and a contrast-safe palette added: navy text on green buttons, plus a deep green for links (Part 12).
8	**Three separate waitlists** (Skills, Ideas, Community) with different CTAs.	One waitlist with interest checkboxes.
9	**The “Exchange Ideas” page carries IP risk** and is thin content for a feature that doesn't exist.	Removed from launch and folded into the Skills page as a “Later” roadmap item.
10	**Internal notes in public copy**, e.g. the FAQ says “This policy must be confirmed before launch.” Citation residue (“Swap Brand Strategy”) appears mid-sentence.	Public copy and internal notes are now visually separate (Build notes and Confirm flags).
11	**Missing India compliance:** no Grievance Officer, no DPDP consent, no age policy, no prohibited-items list.	Legal page set and compliance checklist added (Part 13). Concrete prohibited items and India-specific scam warnings added to the Safety Centre.
12	**Missing product states:** no copy for declined, countered, expired or withdrawn offers, chat, errors, 404, notifications or emails.	Full microcopy set: 70+ strings (Part 10).
13	**Listing card shows ₹ value prominently**, which undercuts the “Don't Buy. Don't Sell.” promise even though v1 says to put “Looking For” first.	Card spec puts Have/Want first. The value is optional, small and labelled “Approx. value”.
14	**Weak navigation:** “Home” wastes a slot (the logo already links home). Safety, the key trust page, is buried in the footer.	Nav is now Explore · Categories · How It Works · Safety, with a mobile bottom bar built around **+ List**.

PART 02

Brand foundation & messaging rules

These rules keep every page, ad and notification sounding like one brand.

Positioning statement

For students and young professionals in India **who** have useful things they no longer use, **Swap is** the social marketplace **that** lets them swap those things directly for what they actually want, and lets Pro members auction verified items, **unlike** resale apps, where everything starts and ends with price.

Messaging hierarchy: three lines, three jobs

Role	Line	Where it's used
Tagline What we are	**Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange.** Subline: India's first exchange marketplace from God's Own Country.	Homepage H1, logo lock-up, app-store subtitle, ads, social bios, footer. RESTORED IN V4
Promise Why it matters	**Everything Has Value.**	About page, brand story, onboarding screen 1, campaign headlines.
Action line What to do	**Got Something? Get Something.**	Final CTAs, empty states, social posts, packaging and print.

WHY THE TAGLINE STILL FITS WITH AUCTIONS

Most of Swap is item-for-item exchange. Auctions are a small, verified, 18+ layer for Pro members, so the brand promise stays about exchange. Never lead an ad with auctions under this tagline; lead with swapping.

RETIRED LINES (DO NOT USE)

"Swap freely. Bid boldly." (the v3 tagline, retired in v4) · "Discover Yours" · "List It. Match It. Exchange It." · "Your Stuff. Your Value. Your Next Exchange." · "Simple. Smart. Rewarding." · "More Value. More Possibilities. Less Waste." · "It's Not About Having More Money…" · "Different Needs. Different Products. Endless Possibilities." · "The Smarter Way to Exchange". Each is fine on its own, but together they dilute the three lines above.

CTA system

Type	Label	Rule
Primary	List an Item	The supply-side action. New marketplaces live or die on listings, so this is the most prominent button on every page. Green fill, navy text.
Secondary	Explore Exchanges	The browse action. Outline style. Always paired with the primary.
On a swap listing	Offer a Swap	The only primary button on swap cards and swap pages. Teal.
On an auction NEW	Place Bid	Gold. Changes with the format: "Buy Now" (price drop), "Seal a Bid" (sealed), "Bid or Swap" (swap or bid).

In the app NEW	Create	Opens the Create page: offer a swap, ask for something, share a swap (everyone), plus the Pro Plus studio: auction, lucky draw, giveaway, challenge, mystery box, video. V4
Future features	Join the Waitlist	For everything marked Coming soon. One waitlist for all of them.
Text links	See how it works →	For learning more. Never style these as buttons.

Voice & tone

WE SOUND

- **Friendly:** like a smart friend, not a bank.
- **Clear:** short sentences, everyday words, one idea per line.
- **Confident:** "You decide" rather than "Users may be able to".
- **Indian:** local examples (cricket kit, exam guides, Kochi, Pune) and Indian English spelling (colour, centre, programme).
- **Optimistic:** about resourcefulness, never about scarcity.

WE NEVER

- Imply users are broke or "can't afford" things.
- Promise outcomes: "guaranteed", "100% safe", "verified" (until it's true).
- Use legalese in marketing copy ("eligible", "facilitate", "applicable").
- Stack buzzwords ("seamless", "revolutionary", "ecosystem").
- Shame anyone about consumption.

Word list

Use	Instead of	Notes
exchange	trade, deal, transaction	Default verb and noun in the UI.
swap	—	Fine in casual copy, social posts and SEO. Not in buttons.
barter	—	Only in SEO pages, blog posts and explanations ("a modern barter marketplace"). It's a search term, not our UI voice.
item	product	"Product" sounds like retail. Use "item" in the UI. SEO pages may use "products", because people search for it.
member	user, customer, seller	"Swap Traders" is the community name. Use it in community and marketing copy, not in system messages.
approx. value	price, worth, cost	On swaps, never say "price". We don't price swaps.
bid, top bid NEW	offer (on auctions)	"Offer" is for swaps and "bid" is for auctions. Never mix them. "Price" is allowed only on auctions.
Pro NEW	premium, seller account	Always "Pro", in capitals on badges (PRO).
SwapSafe NEW	wallet, payment hold	The name for auction escrow. Use it only once a licensed payment partner runs it.
verified item NEW	certified, guaranteed, authentic	Means our checks passed, not that we guarantee the item.
offer	bid, request	"Make an Offer", "Offer received".

WRITING LIMITS

Per page: “discover” at most twice, “opportunity/possibility” at most once each, “eligible” never in marketing copy. Hero body ≤ 25 words. Section intros ≤ 30 words. Card descriptions ≤ 15 words.

PART 03

Launch modes

v1 ended by asking whether Swap launches as a working marketplace or a waitlist site. The copy in this playbook supports both. Design once, then switch with the table below.

MODE A · LIVE MARKETPLACE

Members can sign up, list, offer and exchange. **Choose this if** the listing → offer → chat → complete flow is built and tested, and at least 300 seed listings exist in the launch city.

MODE B · WAITLIST (PRE-LAUNCH)

The site explains the concept and collects sign-ups by city. **Choose this if** the product isn't ready, or to build launch-day supply ("list your first item early").

RECOMMENDATION

Run **Mode B for 4–8 weeks in one city** (e.g. Kochi, or a single campus cluster), and invite waitlisters to **pre-list items**. Switch to Mode A when the city reaches your seed-listing target. An exchange marketplace with empty shelves loses visitors permanently. A waitlist with momentum builds trust.

Swap table

Element	Mode A · Live	Mode B · Waitlist
Hero primary CTA	List an Item	Get Early Access (inline email/mobile + city field)
Hero secondary CTA	Explore Exchanges	See how it works →
Hero microline	Free to join · Exchange on your terms	Launching first in {city}. Be one of the first Swap Traders.
Homepage Section 2	Live listings near you	"Exchanges we can't wait to see": illustrated examples
How It Works heading	Your first exchange in three steps	Here's how it'll work
Header button	+ List an Item	Get Early Access
Final CTA	List an Item / Explore Exchanges	Join the waitlist form
Explore, Categories	Live	Hidden from nav. URLs redirect to /#waitlist
FAQ	Full set	Add: "When does Swap launch in my city?"

Waitlist form (Mode B, and Coming soon features)	COMPONENT
HEADING	**Be first in line.**
BODY	We're opening city by city. Join the list and we'll tell you the moment Swap goes live near you.
FIELDS	First name · Email or mobile number · City (dropdown + "Other") · *Optional:* What would you list first? (placeholder: "e.g., my old bicycle")

INTERESTS	☐ Exchanging items ☐ Skills & services (coming soon) ☐ Campus ambassador programme
CONSENT	☐ I'm 15 or older (under 18s need a parent's or guardian's consent) and agree to receive launch updates from Swap. I can unsubscribe anytime. Privacy Policy
BUTTON	**Join the Waitlist**
SUCCESS	**You're on the list!** We'll let you know as soon as Swap opens in {city}. Want to move up? Share your invite link with friends.
ERROR	“Please enter a valid email or 10-digit mobile number.” · “You're already on the list. We'll be in touch soon.”

PART 04

Sitemap, navigation & footer

Pages at launch

Page	URL	Job	Status
Home	`/`	Explain in 5 seconds, show listings, drive the first listing	CHANGED
Explore	`/explore`	Browse and filter live listings	CHANGED
Categories	`/categories`, `/categories/{slug}`	Browse by category. Category pages double as SEO landing pages	CHANGED
How It Works	`/how-it-works`	Full guide for first-timers	CHANGED
Exchange Products	`/exchange-products`	SEO landing page for "exchange / swap products online"	CHANGED
Auction House	`/auctions`	Browse Pro auctions by format	NEW
Pro	`/pro`	Plans, the auction formats, how SwapSafe works	NEW
Auction rules	`/auction-rules`	Binding bids, anti-sniping, escrow, disputes, fees	NEW
Skills & Services	`/exchange-skills`	Coming soon page and waitlist	COMING SOON
Safety Centre	`/safety`	Trust, tips, prohibited items, scam warnings	CHANGED
About Us	`/about`	Story, mission, team, roadmap	CHANGED
Help & FAQs	`/help`	Grouped answers	CHANGED
Contact	`/contact`	Support plus Grievance Officer details	CHANGED
Blog	`/blog`	SEO and education	—
Legal set	`/terms` `/privacy` `/prohibited-items` `/community-guidelines` `/grievance`	Required before launch (Part 13)	NEW
Exchange Ideas	~~`/exchange-ideas`~~	Folded into Skills page as a "Later" roadmap item. Reason: IP and confidentiality risk, thin content, splits attention	CUT

App pages (copy in Part 10): Sign up / Log in · Onboarding · Create listing · Listing detail · My listings · Offers (sent / received) · Chat · Profile · Settings · Report · 404.

Header

DESKTOP

[Logo] Explore · Auctions · How It Works · Safety [Search: "What do you want?"] Log In **+ List an Item**

"Home" is removed because the logo links home. "About" moves to the footer, since visitors rarely need it to act. "Safety" goes in the header because trust is the #1 barrier for exchanges with strangers.

MOBILE: STICKY BOTTOM BAR

Home · Auctions · **[+ Create]** (raised, gold-to-teal) · Swipe · Profile

Top bar: logo, search icon, menu. Menu holds Categories, How It Works, Safety, About, Help.

Footer NEW

Exchange	Company	Help	Legal
Explore Exchanges	About Us	Help & FAQs	Terms of Use
Auction House	Blog	Safety Centre	Privacy Policy
Categories	Campus Programme	Report an Issue	Auction Rules
How It Works	Press	Community Guidelines	Prohibited Items
List an Item	Contact		Grievance Officer
Go Pro			Cookie Settings
Skills & Services SOON			

Footer brand block	COPY
LINE 1	**Swap**. Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange. A HPY initiative · Made with ♥ in Kochi.
LINE 2	India's exchange marketplace for the things you don't use and the things you want.
LEGAL LINE	© 2026 {Registered Company Name}. All rights reserved. Made in India. Swap connects members. Exchanges are agreed and completed between members.

PART 05

Homepage: final copy

Eight sections instead of twelve, in the order of v1's own recommended user journey: explain → show → guide → reassure → act. Everything above the fold must work on a 360 px phone.

#	Section	Visitor question it answers	From v1
1	Hero	What is this?	S1, tightened
2	Live exchanges	Is anyone actually here?	S5 + S7 merged
3	How it works	How hard is it?	S3, 4 → 3 steps
4	Categories	Can I exchange my stuff?	S4 + S9 teaser
5	Why exchange	Why not just sell it on OLX?	S2 + S6 merged
6	Fair exchange	How is value decided?	S8, shortened
7	Safety	Can I trust strangers?	S10
8	Final CTA	OK, what now?	S11 + S12 merged

Section 1: Hero	ABOVE THE FOLD
EYEBROW	INDIA'S MODERN BARTER MARKETPLACE
H1	**Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange.**
SUBHEAD	Trade the things you no longer use for things you actually want, directly with people near you.
SEARCH	Placeholder: *What do you want? Try "cycle" or "guitar"* + location chip: *{city}*▾
CTAS	List an Item · Explore Exchanges
MICROLINE	✓ Free to join ✓ No buying or selling ✓ You decide what's fair
VISUAL	An animated Have/Want card: **I HAVE** Bicycle ⇄ **I WANT** Guitar, cycling through 3–4 pairs. Caption: *Two people. Two things. One fair exchange.*

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Use "Free to join" only once the pricing policy is final. If it isn't, use "Exchange on your terms" instead.

BUILD NOTE

"Barter" is in the eyebrow on purpose. It puts the main SEO keyword near the H1 without breaking the tagline. Mode B: swap the CTAs and microline as in Part 03.

Section 2: Live exchanges	DYNAMIC
EYEBROW	FRESH ON SWAP
H2	**See what people near you want to exchange**
CONTENT	8 most recent listings within 25 km of {city}, as Have/Want cards (spec in Part 12). Horizontal scroll on mobile, 4–column grid on desktop.
LINK	Explore Exchanges
FALLBACK	If there are fewer than 8 listings nearby, show example cards with an **"Example"** badge. Heading: **"Exchanges waiting to happen"** Old smartphone ⇄ Bicycle · Textbooks ⇄ Headphones · Guitar ⇄ Camera · Study table ⇄ Dumbbells Footnote: *Examples only. Real exchanges depend on what members list.*

Section 2b: Live auctions NEW	DYNAMIC
EYEBROW	AUCTION HOUSE
H2	**Bid on verified items**
BODY	Every auction is run by a Pro seller, and every item is checked before it goes live. Your money waits in SwapSafe escrow until you confirm the item.
CONTENT	4 auctions ending soonest: photo, format chip, top bid, live countdown. A LIVE banner goes first when a Live drop is running.
CTAS	See all auctions · Sell by auction (Pro) →

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Hide Section 2b until auctions launch (recommended: phase 2).

Section 3: How it works	3 STEPS
H2	**Your first exchange in three steps**
STEP 1	**List what you have.** Add a few photos, the condition, and what you'd like in return.
STEP 2	**Make or get an offer.** Found something you like? Offer one of your items. Or let offers come to you.
STEP 3	**Agree and exchange.** Chat, settle the details, meet up and swap. Then rate each other.
CTAS	List an Item · See the full guide →

Section 4: Categories	GRID
H2	**What can you exchange?**

INTRO	Everyday things, from gadgets to guitars.
CARDS	**Electronics & Gadgets** Phones, laptops, cameras, headphones, gaming gear **Books & Study** Textbooks, novels, exam guides, stationery **Fashion & Accessories** Bags, watches, shoes, clothes in good condition **Kids & Toys** NEW Toys, books, ride-ons. Children grow, so items rotate. **Home & Furniture** Tables, chairs, shelves, appliances, décor **Sports & Fitness** Bicycles, gym gear, cricket kits, outdoor gear **Hobbies & Music** Instruments, art supplies, board games, collectibles **Skills & Services** COMING SOON Trade what you can do. Join the waitlist
LINK	View all categories →

BUILD NOTE

Each card shows a live count: "{n} items near you". Hide the count below 5 so empty categories don't look empty. Kids & Toys was added because families are a stated secondary audience. Exclude car seats, cribs and other safety-critical baby items (see Prohibited Items).

Section 5: Why exchange	4 BENEFITS
H2	**Why exchange instead of sell?**
BENEFIT 1	**Get what you want, without spending on it.** Your unused things become your currency.
BENEFIT 2	**Clear the clutter, usefully.** The phone in your drawer is exactly what someone is looking for.
BENEFIT 3	**Your terms, always.** You choose what to offer and what to accept. Nothing happens unless you both agree.
BENEFIT 4	**Less waste.** Every exchange keeps a good thing in use and out of a landfill.

Section 6: Fair exchange	OBJECTION HANDLER
H2	**Who decides what's fair? You both do.**
BODY	There are no price tags on Swap. Condition, usefulness and how much you want something all count. Ask questions, compare details and agree when it feels right to both of you.
SMALL PRINT	Approx. values, where shown, are a guide only. They are not a price or a guarantee.

FUTURE SLOT

When ValueMatch (smart value matching) launches, add a line here: "Not sure? ValueMatch suggests fair exchanges based on similar items."

Section 7: Safety	TRUST
H2	**Exchange with confidence**

TIPS	**Check the details** Read the description, study the photos, ask questions. **Keep chats on Swap** It keeps a record and your number stays private. **Meet somewhere public** Daylight, busy places, and test items before you swap. **Report anything off** One tap flags a listing or member to our team.
LINK	Visit the Safety Centre →
DISCLAIMER	Exchanges are agreed between members. Swap can't guarantee every item or outcome. That's why we share these tips.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Mention **verified members**, **ratings** or **dispute support** only once each is live. When verification launches, add the tip: "Look for the ✓ Verified badge".

Section 8: Final CTA	CLOSE
H2	**Got Something? Get Something.**
BODY	Someone near you may want exactly what you have, and have exactly what you want. Join the Swap Traders.
CTAS	List an Item · Explore Exchanges

PART 06

Core pages: final copy

SEO titles and meta descriptions for every page are in Part 11. Only the on-page copy is shown here.

How It Works /how-it-works

Hero	PAGE
H1	**How Swap works**
SUBHEAD	Have something? Find something. Exchange it. Here's everything you need for your first exchange.

Five steps	NUMBERED LIST WITH ILLUSTRATIONS
1 · JOIN	**Create your free account.** Sign up with your mobile number or email. Add a photo and your city so members know who they're exchanging with.
2 · LIST	**List what you have.** Add: • 3–6 clear photos (natural light, show any wear) • A title, category and condition • A short, honest description • What you'd like in return, or tick *Open to offers* • Approx. value (optional)
3 · EXPLORE	**Find what you want.** Search or browse by category and distance. Turn on *Matches for me* to see members who want what you have.
4 · OFFER	**Make an offer.** Choose one of your listed items, add a friendly note and send. The other member can accept, decline or suggest something else.
5 · EXCHANGE	**Agree, meet, swap.** Confirm the details in chat, meet somewhere public, check the items, and exchange. Then mark it complete and rate each other.

Good to know	ACCORDION
COSTS	The exchange itself is free. If you agree to courier an item, you and the other member decide who pays.
CHANGED MIND?	You can withdraw an offer until it's accepted. After that, talk to the other member first.
NOT ALLOWED	Illegal, stolen, counterfeit, unsafe or adult items. See the full list.
PRO TIP	Listings with 4+ photos and a clear "I want" get noticeably more offers.
CTA	List Your First Item Read safety tips →

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

"Matches for me", "suggest something else" (counter-offers) and "Pro tip" claims depend on what is built and measured. Remove any that aren't true at launch.

Explore /explore NEW COPY

Explore page	FUNCTIONAL
H1	**Explore exchanges near {city}**
FILTERS	Category · Distance (5 / 10 / 25 / 50 km / Anywhere) · Condition · **Wants something I have** (toggle) · **Open to offers** (toggle)
SORT	Newest · Nearest · Best match for me
RESULTS LINE	{n} items near {city}
NO RESULTS	**Nothing here yet.** Try a wider distance, or list what you have. The right person may find you first. List an Item
SAVED SEARCH	Tell me when someone lists "{query}" near me

WHY THE "WANTS SOMETHING I HAVE" FILTER MATTERS

It turns v1's Have/Want idea into a product feature. It surfaces *mutual* matches, which is the hard part of any barter system (the "double coincidence of wants"). It's also the clearest difference from resale apps.

Category page template /categories/{slug}

Template + 3 examples	SEO LANDING
H1	Exchange {category} near you
INTRO (40–60 WORDS)	**Electronics:** Swap your old phone, laptop, headphones or camera for something you'll actually use. Browse electronics listed by members near you, see what each owner wants in return, and make an offer. Always test devices before you exchange, and factory-reset your own first. **Books & Study:** Finished with last semester's textbooks? Exchange them for the ones you need next, or for headphones, a cycle or anything else on your list. Students across India are swapping books, exam guides and study gear on Swap. **Home & Furniture:** Moving, upgrading or just making space? Exchange tables, chairs, shelves and appliances with people nearby. Large items are easiest to exchange locally, so filter by distance and agree on pick-up in chat.
BELOW GRID	3 category-specific tips + 4 FAQs (marked up as FAQPage schema) + link to the related blog article.

Exchange Products /exchange-products

SEO landing page	PAGE
H1	**Exchange products online in India**
INTRO	An old phone. A spare chair. A cycle you've outgrown. They're doing nothing for you, but they could be exactly what someone else is looking for. On Swap, you swap them directly for things you want. No buying, no selling.
CTAS	List an Item · Browse Products
H2 + BODY	**What can you swap?** Category grid (same as homepage Section 4).
H2 + EXAMPLE	**How a swap works.** You have a study table and want a cycle. Arjun, 3 km away, has a cycle and needs a table. You chat, agree, meet and swap. Two people, both better off, and no money changed hands.
H2 + BODY	**Exchanging vs. selling.** Selling means haggling over price, then spending the money on what you wanted anyway. Exchanging skips the middle step: one conversation, one meet-up, done.
CLOSE	**Make your unused things useful again.** List an Item

Skills & Services /exchange-skills COMING SOON

Coming soon page	ABSORBS V1 "EXCHANGE IDEAS"
BADGE	COMING SOON
H1	**Your skills have value too.**
SUBHEAD	Soon you'll be able to exchange what you can *do*, not just what you own.
EXAMPLES	Logo design ⇄ Photography · Guitar lessons ⇄ Maths tutoring · Website build ⇄ Video editing · Spoken English ⇄ Coding help
H2	**What we're planning** **Creative:** design, illustration, photography, video · **Tech:** websites, coding, device help · **Learning:** tutoring, languages, music · **Marketing:** content, copywriting, social media
HOW IT'LL WORK	Both members agree on clear deliverables, timelines and what "done" looks like before anyone starts.
LATER	Further ahead, we're exploring exchanges of defined creative and expert work, such as consulting sessions and learning materials. These will need clear agreements on ownership and confidentiality.
CTA	Inline waitlist form (Skills pre-ticked). Button: **Join the Waitlist**
FOOTNOTE	Skills & Services isn't available yet. Product exchanges are live now. Explore them.

WHY "EXCHANGE IDEAS" WAS CUT

Inviting people to "exchange ideas" on a public site encourages them to post unprotected concepts. That leads to IP disputes and confidentiality claims, and posting an idea gives it no legal protection. It also adds a third "future" page that dilutes the launch message. Reconsider it only with proper legal terms (NDAs, assignment clauses) in place.

About Us /about

About page	PAGE
H1	**Everything has value.**
SUBHEAD	Even the things you've stopped using.
OUR STORY	Every home in India has them: the phone in the drawer, the cycle on the balcony, the textbooks from last year. Meanwhile, someone a few kilometres away is about to buy exactly those things new. Buying and selling has always been the only way to connect them. We asked a simple question: **why not just exchange?** Swap is our answer, a marketplace where the first question isn't "How much?" but "What would you take for it?"
MISSION	Make exchanging things as easy as buying them.
VISION	An India where exchanging is a natural, trusted alternative to buying, and nothing useful goes to waste.

WHAT WE BELIEVE	**Everything has value** What you don't need is exactly what someone else wants. **Fair means both sides** A good exchange leaves two people happy. **Trust is earned** Honest listings, clear chats and real accountability. **Small choices add up** Every exchange is one less thing bought new.
WHERE WE'RE HEADED	**Now:** item-for-item exchanges → **Next:** skills & services, smart matching → **Later:** multi-item exchanges, more cities
TEAM NEW	Founder photos, names, one line each and home city. *"Built in {city} by people who had too many old phones."*
CTA	**Join the Swap Traders.** List an Item

BUILD NOTE

Real faces are the single biggest trust signal for a new marketplace. Don't launch the About page without the team section.

Safety Centre /safety

Safety Centre	PAGE
H1	**Exchange smart. Exchange safely.**
INTRO	Most exchanges go smoothly. A few simple habits make sure yours does too.
BEFORE	**Read the listing properly.** Check photos, age, condition and any defects. **Ask anything.** Unclear? Ask before you agree. Honest members don't mind. **Check the profile.** Look at member since, completed exchanges and ratings. **Agree on value together.** Approx. values are a guide. What matters is that you both feel it's fair.
DURING	**Confirm in chat.** Write down exactly what's being exchanged, when and where. **Meet in public.** A café, mall, metro station or campus gate, in daylight. Bring a friend for high-value items. **Test before you swap.** Switch devices on, check accessories, try bikes and instruments. **For phones and laptops:** check the IMEI or serial number, ask for the bill if available, and make sure it's logged out of all accounts.
AFTER	**Mark it complete** and **leave an honest rating**. It helps the next person. Something went wrong? **Report it** within 7 days.

Spot a scam NEW	INDIA-SPECIFIC RED FLAGS
INTRO	**Stop and report** if anyone:
RED FLAGS	× Asks for an **OTP**, password or UPI PIN. Swap will never ask for these. × Sends a **UPI "collect" request or QR code**. Scanning a QR code is for *paying*, never for receiving. × Asks for a **"courier fee", "deposit" or "verification charge"** before the exchange. × Pushes you to **move to WhatsApp** or another app straight away. × Won't meet, won't show the item on a video call, or creates **urgency** ("someone else wants it, decide now"). × Offers something that seems **too good to be true**, e.g. a new iPhone for an old textbook.
HELP	Report in-app: ··· → **Report**. Cyber fraud: call the National Cyber Crime Helpline **1930** or visit **cybercrime.gov.in**. Emergency: **112**.

What can't be exchanged	SUMMARY. FULL LIST AT /PROHIBITED-ITEMS
INTRO	Keep it legal and safe. These items aren't allowed on Swap:
LIST	Weapons, ammunition and explosives · Drugs, medicines and medical devices · Alcohol, tobacco and vapes · Stolen or counterfeit goods · Live animals and wildlife products · Adult content · Hazardous or recalled items · Car seats, cribs and other safety-critical baby gear · Government IDs, SIM cards and financial instruments · Vehicles and property (at launch) · Digital accounts, gift cards and vouchers
CTAS	Report an Issue Community Guidelines →
DISCLAIMER	Swap connects members. Exchanges are agreed and completed between them. We can't guarantee every member, item or outcome, but we act on every report.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Have counsel review the prohibited list. Decide on vehicles: they require an RC transfer, so they are excluded at launch. "We act on every report" and the 7-day reporting window need an operational owner and SLA.

Contact /contact

Contact page	PAGE
H1	**How can we help?**
SUBHEAD	Most answers are in Help & FAQs. Still stuck? Send us a message. We usually reply within {X} working hours.
TOPIC DROPDOWN	My account · A listing · An offer or exchange · Report a member or scam · Partnerships & campus programme · Media & press · Something else
FIELDS	Full name · Email · Mobile (optional) · Topic · Listing or offer ID (optional, shown for listing/offer topics) · Message · Attach screenshot (optional)
BUTTON	Send Message
SUCCESS	**Got it, thanks!** Your ticket number is {ticketId}. We'll reply to {email} soon.
GRIEVANCE BLOCK	**Grievance Officer** {Name}, {Designation} {email} · {postal address} We acknowledge complaints within 24 hours and resolve them within 15 days, as required under the IT (Intermediary Guidelines) Rules, 2021.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

The Grievance Officer details and timelines are legal requirements for intermediaries and e-commerce entities in India. Counsel must confirm which rules apply to Swap and the exact SLAs. Never publish placeholder contact details.

PART 07

The social app NEW

The app works like a social network where every post is something to swap or bid on. People come back for the feed, and stay because it finds them matches.

App sections

Section	Job	Key elements
Home feed	Daily reason to open the app	Stories row · post box ("Swap it, ask for it, or auction it…") · tabs: For you, Auctions, Nearby, Following
Stories	Quick, 24-hour updates	Each story shows Has ⇄ Wants. A red LIVE ring marks a live auction and opens it in one tap. Replies go to chat.
Auction House	Where buyers browse auctions	LIVE NOW banner · filters by format · cards with countdown timers · "Seven ways to sell" explainer
Swipe	Fast matching	Card stack. Right = offer a swap, left = pass, ★ = save. A teal badge shows when the owner wants one of your items.
Explore	Search	Search box, category chips (incl. Bike & Car V4), a grid of swaps and auctions
Messages	Agree the details	Swap offers appear as cards with Accept / Decline · quick replies · safety banner · scam-word warning · voice and video calls for Pro Plus V4
Notifications	Pull people back	New offers, matches, outbid alerts, auction ending, follows, ratings
Profile	Trust	4-second motion picture and cover V4 · verified tick · PRO badge · Swap Coins card V4 · Women's Circle badge (opt-in) · trust score · swaps, rating, followers · tabs: Has / Wants / Reviews
Pro studio	Selling tools	Plans, your auctions, bids, watchers, top bids total, how auctions work
Create V4	One place to post	Everyone: swap, ask, share a swap. Pro Plus studio: auction, lucky draw, giveaway, challenge, mystery box, video (Part 18)
Coins V4	Reward good swaps	Balance, unlock meter, activity log, Women's Circle (Part 17). Also on your profile and in the top bar.
Draws V4	Free fun, 18+	Weekly free draw, business giveaways, skill quiz, mystery box swaps (Part 19)
Events & Groups V4	Community	Swap meets, fairs, live auctions; topic groups like Kochi Riders Swap (Part 20)

Post types

Type	What it shows	Button
Swap	Photo, Has ⇄ Wants strip, condition, distance, approx. value (optional)	Offer a Swap

Request	“Looking for” card plus what they can offer	I Have This
Auction PRO	Photo, Verified badge, gold bid bar (top bid · bids · ends in), format, watchers	Place Bid
Swap done	Both people, both items, star rating	Congrats
Tip	Official safety or how-to tips	—
Draw · Giveaway · Challenge · Mystery box PRO+ V4	Gold-edged promo card: prize, how to enter, entries, ends in, “Free to enter” (or “Swap only, no payment” for boxes)	Enter free
Video PRO+ V4	Up to 2:00, with player controls and a duration chip	—

Every post supports like (double-tap the photo), comment, share to WhatsApp, and save (called “Watch” on auctions).

Trust score

A score from 0 to 100 on every profile, built from things members can check. Example weighting:

Signal	Weight
Verified phone and ID	25
Completed swaps and auctions	25
Average rating (last 20 deals)	25
Reply rate and on-time meet-ups	15
No upheld reports in 90 days	10

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Show the trust score only once every input is real and the formula is published in Help. Never let money buy trust points: Pro membership must not raise the score.

App copy	SOCIAL SURFACES
POST BOX	Swap it, ask for it, or auction it…
POST TYPES	Offer a swap · Ask for something · Start an auction PRO · Share a swap
FEED END	You're all caught up ✓
SWIPE HEADER	**Swipe to swap.** Right to offer a swap, left to pass.
SWIPE EMPTY	**You've seen everything nearby.** New items appear as people post them.
MATCH BADGE	Wants your {item}!
STORY REPLY	Reply to {firstName}…

PART 08

Pro & auctions NEW

Swapping stays free for everyone. Pro and Pro Plus members aged 23+ can bid on and sell **verified** items by auction, with payment held in SwapSafe escrow. Members 18–22 can watch; teens don't see auctions.

Who can do what

Action	Free	Pro	Pro Plus
Swap, request, chat, swipe, stories, watch auctions	✓	✓	✓
Bid on auctions (23+, verified phone)	—	✓	✓
Sell by auction (verified items only)	—	3 / month	Unlimited
Auction formats	—	3	All 7
Auto-bid, seller analytics, boosted posts	—	—	✓
Creator studio and voice / video calls V4	—	—	✓

Plans (example pricing)

Plan	Price	Includes
Free	₹0	Swaps, requests, stories, chat, swipe matching, events, groups, Swap Coins. Watch auctions.
Pro PRO	₹149 / month	Everything in Free, bid on every auction, sell up to 3 auctions a month in 3 formats (Classic, Reserve, Bid or Buy Now), verified-item badge. 5% fee only when an item sells.
Pro Plus PRO+	₹399 / month	Everything in Pro, unlimited auctions in all 7 formats, auto-bid, seller analytics, boosted posts, priority verification, the creator studio (Part 18), voice and video calls. 3% fee when an item sells.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

Prices, any trial, and the 5% / 3% fees are example pricing. Paid plans are 18+ only. Test them with real sellers. GST applies to both the subscription and the fee.

Item verification (required before an auction goes live)

1. **Proof of purchase:** a bill, invoice or order screenshot.
2. **Serial number or IMEI** for electronics, cameras and watches. Check IMEI against the government CEIR blacklist.
3. **Ownership statement:** the seller confirms the item isn't stolen, counterfeit or prohibited.
4. **Photo check:** our team compares the listing photos with the documents.

Badge copy: "✓ Verified item". Help text: "Our team checked the documents and photos. This isn't a guarantee of condition."

Seven bidding formats

Format	How the winner is decided	Seller sets

Live drop	10-minute live auction. Highest bid when the timer ends.	Starting bid, increment
Classic	Highest bid when the timer ends.	Starting bid, increment, 1 hour to 7 days
Reserve	As Classic, but it sells only if the hidden reserve is met. Shows "Reserve met / not met".	Starting bid, reserve, increment
Sealed bid	One secret bid each. The highest is revealed and wins at the end.	Minimum bid, end time
Price drop	The price falls by a set step every few minutes. The first person to tap "Buy now" wins.	Start price, floor, drop step
Bid or Buy Now	Classic, plus a fixed Buy Now price that disappears once bids reach it.	Starting bid, Buy Now price, increment
⇄ Swap or Bid	Bidders offer cash or one of their items. The seller picks the winner.	Starting bid, increment, wanted items

Bidding rules

- **Bids are binding.** A winner who doesn't pay gets a strike. Three strikes block bidding.
- **Anti-sniping:** any bid in the last 2 minutes adds 2 minutes to the timer.
- **Auto-bid:** buyers set a private maximum, and the app bids one increment at a time on their behalf.
- **Increments:** default to about 5% of the starting bid, rounded to ₹50.
- **No shill bidding:** sellers and their linked accounts can't bid on their own auctions.
- **Outbid alerts:** sent by push straight away, and again 15 minutes before the end if the member is watching.
- **Bid history** is public (handle, amount, time), except in sealed auctions.
- **No cash outside the app.** Paying off-platform means no protection and leads to account removal.

SwapSafe escrow flow

#	Step	Deadline (example)
1	Auction ends. The winner is notified: "You won! Pay into SwapSafe to complete."	—
2	The winner pays through UPI or card. The money is held by the licensed payment partner, not paid to the seller.	Within 24 hours
3	Hand-over in person, or the seller ships with tracking.	Within 3 days
4	The buyer taps "Item received as described", or opens a dispute.	Within 48 hours of delivery
5	The seller is paid, minus the 5% fee. If the buyer doesn't respond, the money is released automatically.	Next working day

DISPUTE PATH

The buyer uploads photos → the seller responds within 48 hours → our team decides (refund, return, or release) within 5 working days. Publish this flow in the Auction rules page before launch.

Auction microcopy

Element	Copy

Pro gate	**This needs Pro.** Swapping is free forever. Selling by auction needs Pro, with your item verified first. **See plans**
Verification error	Confirm proof of purchase and ownership. Only verified items can be auctioned.
Auction live	Your auction is live Bids will start rolling in.
Bid placed	You're the top bidder at {amount}
Bid too low	Bid at least {minNext}.
Outbid	You've been outbid on {item}. **Bid again**
Late bid	Late bid! Timer extended by 2 minutes.
Auto-bid on	Auto-bid on, up to {max}. We bid for you, one step at a time.
Sealed bid	Sealed. Good luck at the reveal! / Your sealed bid of {amount} is in.
Reserve	✓ Reserve met / Reserve not met
Won	It's yours! Pay into SwapSafe escrow to complete.
Ended	This auction has ended.
Legal line (every auction)	Bids are binding. A bid in the last 2 minutes adds 2 minutes. The winner pays into SwapSafe escrow, and the seller is paid after the item is confirmed.

PART 09

FAQs (rewritten)

Grouped into five topics, with plain answers and no internal notes. NEW marks questions v1 missed. Mark up with FAQPage schema.

The basics

Question	Answer
What is Swap?	An online marketplace where you exchange things you don't use for things you want, directly with other people. No buying, no selling.
How is this different from OLX or Quikr? NEW	On resale apps you sell for money, then spend it. On Swap you skip the money and swap directly. Every listing shows what the owner *has* and what they *want*, so you can spot a match instantly.
Is it free?	Yes. Joining, swapping, browsing, chatting and earning Swap Coins are free. Pro (₹149 / month) adds bidding and a few auctions; Pro Plus (₹399 / month) unlocks everything. Both are optional and 18+.
Who can join? NEW	Anyone aged 18 or over in India with a valid mobile number or email.
Which cities is Swap in? NEW	We're starting in {launch cities}, but you can list and browse from anywhere in India. The more people near you who join, the more matches you'll find.

Listing & offers

Question	Answer
What can I list?	Most everyday items: electronics, furniture, books, sports gear, fashion, hobbies, kids' items and more. A few things aren't allowed. See Prohibited Items.
What if I don't know what I want in return? NEW	Tick *Open to offers*. Members will suggest items, and you choose whether any of them works for you.
How do I make an offer?	Tap **Make an Offer** on any listing, choose one of your items, add a note and send. You'll be notified when they reply.
Can I cancel an offer?	Yes, any time before it's accepted. Once it's accepted, talk to the other member in chat before changing plans.
Can I exchange several items for one?	Not yet. Multi-item exchanges are on our roadmap. For now, each offer is one item for one item.

Value & costs

Question	Answer
How do we decide if an exchange is fair?	You decide together. Approx. values can help, but condition, usefulness and how much you each want the item matter just as much. If it doesn't feel fair, don't agree. There's always another match.
Can I add cash to balance a swap? NEW	No. Swaps are item-for-item. Cash is only used in Pro auctions, and always through SwapSafe escrow.
Are there any costs at all?	The exchange is free. If you choose to courier an item, the two of you agree on who pays for delivery.

Can I exchange with someone in another city?	Yes, as long as you both agree on how the items will travel and who pays. Local exchanges are simpler and let you check items in person.
Is exchanging legal in India?	Yes. Exchanging your personal belongings is legal. If you exchange regularly as a business, GST and other rules may apply, so check with a tax adviser.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

"Is it free?", "Who can join?" and "Can I add cash?" depend on the four founder decisions on page 2. The legal and tax answer must be reviewed by counsel or a CA.

Safety & problems

Question	Answer
Is it safe?	Most exchanges go smoothly, and like meeting anyone new, a little care goes a long way. Chat on Swap, meet in public, test items first and follow our safety tips.
Is my phone number shown to others? NEW	No. Members talk through Swap chat. You choose whether to share your number.
What if I get something different from what was promised?	Report it from the exchange page within 7 days, with photos and chat details. We'll review it and may warn, suspend or remove the other member.
What if someone doesn't show up? NEW	Message them in chat first. If they've disappeared, cancel the exchange and report them. Repeated no-shows lead to account restrictions.
Does Swap handle delivery?	Not yet. Members arrange handovers themselves. We're exploring delivery partners for the future.

Auctions & Pro NEW

Question	Answer
Who can sell by auction?	Pro members, and only items that pass verification: proof of purchase, a serial number or IMEI where there is one, and a photo check.
Which auction formats are there?	Seven: Live drop, Classic, Reserve, Sealed bid, Price drop, Bid or Buy Now, and Swap or Bid. Each listing shows its format.
Can I cancel a bid?	No. Bids are binding, so only bid what you're ready to pay.
What is SwapSafe?	Escrow for auctions. Your payment is held safely until you confirm the item arrived as described. Then the seller is paid.
What if the item isn't as described?	Open a dispute within 48 hours of delivery. Your money stays in SwapSafe while our team reviews it.
Why did the timer go up?	A bid in the last 2 minutes adds 2 minutes, so everyone gets a fair chance to respond.

Coming soon

Question	Answer
Can I exchange skills or services?	Soon! Skills & Services is our next big feature. Join the waitlist to be among the first to try it.
Is there an app? NEW	{Yes: download links} / {Not yet. Swap works on any phone browser, and you can add it to your home screen.}

List Your First Item Still have a question? Contact us →

PART 10

Product microcopy & notifications

Every string a member sees, in the order they meet it. v1 had 19 strings. This set covers the full exchange lifecycle, including the unhappy paths.

Sign-up & onboarding

Element	Copy
Sign-up heading	Join Swap. Your first exchange starts here.
Sign-up field	Mobile number or email
Sign-up button	Continue
OTP screen	Enter the 6-digit code sent to {number}. · Resend in {s}s
OTP error	That code didn't work. Check it and try again.
Consent line	By continuing, you confirm you're 15+ (with a parent's or guardian's consent if under 18) and agree to our Terms and Privacy Policy.
Login heading	Welcome back{, firstName}!
Onboarding 1	**Everything has value.** What you don't use could be exactly what someone else wants.
Onboarding 2	**Say what you have, and what you want.** Every listing shows both, so matches are easy to spot.
Onboarding 3	**You decide.** Nothing is exchanged unless you both agree. **Let's Start Exchanging**
Location permission	Allow location to see exchanges near you. We only show your area, never your exact address.
Profile nudge	Add a photo. Members with a profile photo get more replies. **Complete profile**

CHANGE FROM V1

Onboarding is cut from four screens to three, and the "Have/Want" mechanic is taught on screen 2. Every extra screen loses users.

Create a listing

Element	Copy
Page heading	What would you like to exchange?
Photos	Add up to 6 photos. Tip: use daylight and show any marks or wear.
Title placeholder	e.g., Yamaha F310 acoustic guitar
Condition options	New (unused) · Like new · Good · Fair (visible wear) · For parts / not working
Description placeholder	Age, what's included, any defects. Honest listings get better offers.
"I want" field	**What would you like in return?** Placeholder: "e.g., cycle, headphones, books"
Open-to-offers toggle	I'm open to any offers

Approx. value (optional)	Approx. value (₹). Optional. Helps others judge a fair exchange.
Publish button	**Publish Listing**
Success	**Your listing is live!** Share it to find a match faster. **Share**
Missing "I want"	Tell members what you'd like in return, or tick "Open to any offers".
Photo upload failed	That photo didn't upload. Check your connection and try again.
Listing rejected	We couldn't publish this listing because it may break our Community Guidelines: {reason}. Edit it and try again.
Listing inactive (30 days)	Still have your {item}? **Renew listing** or **Mark as exchanged**

Offers & exchanges

Element	Copy
Offer button	**Make an Offer**
Offer sheet heading	Which of your items would you like to offer?
No items to offer	List an item first. Then you can offer it in exchange. **List an Item**
Note placeholder	Say hi and why it's a good match (optional)
Offer sent	**Offer sent!** We'll let you know when {name} replies.
Offer received	**{name} wants to exchange their {theirItem} for your {yourItem}** **View Offer**
Accept / Decline	**Accept** **Decline** **Suggest another item**
Offer accepted	**It's a match!** Chat with {name} to plan your exchange.
Offer declined (to sender)	{name} has passed on this one. Plenty more out there. **Find similar items**
Decline reason (optional)	Not the right item · Value doesn't match · Already exchanged · Too far away
Offer withdrawn	{name} has withdrawn their offer.
Offer expired (7 days)	This offer expired without a reply. **Send again**
Item no longer available	Sorry, this item has already been exchanged. **See similar items**
Mark complete	**We've Exchanged** · Confirm: "Did you receive the {item} as described?" Yes / No, report a problem
Exchange complete	**Exchange complete!** Your {oldItem} has a new home.
Rating prompt	How was your exchange with {name}? ★★★★★ · Item as described? · On time? · Friendly?

Chat, reporting & system

Element	Copy

Chat safety banner	Keep chats on Swap. We'll never ask for your OTP, and no one needs to pay to "unlock" an exchange.
Chat empty state	Say hello and agree on when and where to meet.
Suggested replies	"Is this still available?" · "Can you share another photo?" · "Where would suit you to meet?"
Risky-word warning	*(when a message contains OTP, UPI, QR or "advance")* Careful. Never share OTPs or pay anyone to receive an item. Learn more
Report button	Report
Report reasons	Scam or fraud · Fake or misleading item · Prohibited item · Abusive behaviour · Didn't show up · Something else
Report sent	Thanks for reporting. Our team will review it within {X} hours. You're helping keep Swap safe.
Search: no results	No matches for "{query}" yet. **Get notified when someone lists it**
My listings: empty	**Got something? Get something.** List your first item. It takes a couple of minutes.
Offers: empty	No offers yet. Listings with clear photos and a specific "I want" get more.
No connection	You're offline. We'll reconnect as soon as you're back.
Generic error	Something went wrong on our side. Please try again.
404 page	**This page has been exchanged for… nothing.** Let's get you back. **Go Home** **Explore Exchanges**
Log out	Logged out. See you at your next exchange!
Delete account	Delete your account? Your listings, offers and chats will be removed permanently. **Delete Account**

Auction and Pro messages are in Part 08.

Notifications & emails NEW

Trigger	Push / SMS	Email subject
Welcome	Welcome to Swap! List your first item to start getting offers.	Welcome to Swap, {firstName}
Offer received	{name} wants your {item}! See their offer →	New offer: {theirItem} for your {yourItem}
Offer accepted	It's a match! {name} accepted your offer	It's a match! Plan your exchange with {name}
New chat message	{name}: "{preview}"	(none: push only)
Saved-search hit	Someone near you just listed a {query}	A {query} was just listed near you
Rate reminder (24h)	How did your exchange with {name} go? Rate it in 10 seconds.	How was your exchange?
Inactive (14 days)	{n} new items near you since your last visit. One might be your match.	{n} new exchanges near you

BUILD NOTE

Keep transactional messages (OTP, offers, matches) separate from marketing messages. Marketing needs opt-in consent under the DPDP Act and TRAI rules (DLT registration for SMS).

PART 11

SEO plan

v1 listed keywords but no titles, metas or H1s for most pages. Below is the complete on-page set. Titles are ≤ 60 characters and meta descriptions ≤ 155.

URL	Primary keyword	SEO title	Meta description
/	barter marketplace India	Swap | India's Barter & Exchange Marketplace	Don't buy. Don't sell. Just exchange. Swap the things you don't use for things you want, directly with people near you. Free to join.
/explore	exchange items near me	Explore Exchanges Near You | Swap	Browse phones, books, furniture, bikes and more that people near you want to exchange. See what they want in return and make an offer.
/how-it-works	how to exchange products	How It Works: Exchange Items in 5 Steps | Swap	New to exchanging? Learn how to list an item, find a match, make an offer and swap safely on Swap, India's exchange marketplace.
/exchange-products	exchange products online India	Exchange Products Online in India | Swap	Swap unused electronics, books, furniture, bicycles and more for things you actually want. No buying, no selling. List your first item free.
/categories/electronics	exchange old electronics	Exchange Old Phones & Electronics | Swap	Swap your old phone, laptop, camera or headphones for something you'll use. Browse electronics near you and make an exchange offer.
/categories/books	exchange books online	Exchange Books & Textbooks Online | Swap	Finished with your textbooks? Exchange books, novels and exam guides with readers and students near you on Swap.
/categories/furniture	exchange furniture	Exchange Furniture & Home Items Near You | Swap	Moving or making space? Exchange tables, chairs, shelves and appliances with people nearby. No buying or selling needed.
/exchange-skills	skill exchange platform India	Skill Exchange Platform: Coming Soon | Swap	Trade what you can do: design, tutoring, coding, photography and more. Join the waitlist for Swap's skill exchange.
/safety	safe product exchange tips	Safety Centre: Exchange Safely | Swap	Tips for safe exchanges: checking items, meeting in public, spotting OTP and UPI scams, and what can't be listed on Swap.
/about	Swap	About Swap | Everything Has Value	Why we're building India's exchange marketplace, the people behind it, and where we're headed next.
/help	barter app FAQ	Help & FAQs | Swap	Answers about listing, offers, fair value, costs, safety and delivery on Swap.
/auctions	online auction India used items	Auctions of Verified Items | Swap	Bid on verified, pre-checked items from Pro sellers near you. Seven auction formats, and payment held safely in escrow until you confirm.
/pro	sell used items by auction	Go Pro: Sell by Auction | Swap	Sell verified items by auction in seven formats. Escrow payouts, a verified badge and seller analytics. Swapping stays free.
/contact	—	Contact Us | Swap	Get help with your account, a listing or an exchange, or reach our Grievance Officer.

BUILD NOTE

Each page's H1 is given in Parts 05–06. Use exactly one H1 per page. The homepage H1 is the tagline, so the keyword goes in the title tag and eyebrow.

Technical SEO checklist NEW

- **Schema:** Organization + WebSite (with SearchAction) on home. FAQPage on /help and category pages. BreadcrumbList site-wide. ItemList on /explore.
- **Listings:** don't use Product schema with prices, because it contradicts the brand and fails rich-result rules. Use `noindex` on expired listings and return 410 for deleted ones.
- **City pages** (`/exchange/{city}`): create only once a city has 50+ live listings. Empty programmatic pages hurt rankings.
- **Mode B:** keep Explore and Categories `noindex` until live.
- **Core Web Vitals:** LCP < 2.5 s on 4G. Serve WebP/AVIF listing images at multiple sizes. Lazy-load below the fold.
- **Open Graph:** listing shares render as a Have/Want card image, which turns every WhatsApp share into an ad.
- **Language:** start in English. Add Hindi and Malayalam later with `hreflang`. The suggested heading font supports Devanagari.
- **Validate keywords** in Google Keyword Planner or Search Console before committing. v1's list is a starting hypothesis, not measured volume.

Blog plan: 10 launch articles

#	Title	Target keyword	CTA
1	What Is the Barter System? A Simple Guide (With Modern Examples)	what is barter system	Explore Exchanges
2	How to Exchange Things Without Money: 5 Ways That Work in India	exchange without money	List an Item
3	12 Things in Your Home You Could Exchange This Weekend	things to exchange	List an Item
4	What to Do With Your Old Phone: Sell, Recycle or Exchange?	what to do with old phone	Electronics category
5	Is It a Fair Swap? How to Judge the Value of an Exchange	fair exchange value	How It Works
6	Barter vs. Selling: Which Gets You More?	barter vs selling	Explore Exchanges
7	The Student's Guide to Swapping Textbooks, Gadgets and More	exchange textbooks students	Books category
8	How to Exchange Safely With Strangers (and Spot UPI Scams)	online exchange safety	Safety Centre
9	How Swapping Cuts Waste: The Case for Keeping Things in Use	reduce waste reuse	About
10	How to Write a Listing That Gets Offers (With Examples)	how to write listing	List an Item

Each article: 900–1,400 words, one H1, a real exchange example, a mid-article Have/Want card, an end CTA and 2 internal links. Changes from v1: #1 is reworded to match how people actually search, #3 becomes "weekend" (more actionable), and #8 adds the India-specific scam angle.

PART 12

Design system & UX rules

Colour palette: futuristic neon CHANGED IN V4

v4 moves from champagne-and-teal glass to a futuristic look: deep space, neon cyan, electric violet and hot pink, with glowing edges and a moving grid horizon. The app is still dark by default with a light theme. Each colour keeps one job.

Colour	Dark / light hex	Role	Usage rule
Deep Space	`#04050D` / `#E9EEF8`	Background	Page background behind the grid and glows.
Ice	`#EAF6FF` / `#161A2B`	Text	Main text: 18:1 on Deep Space ✓.
Neon Cyan	`#3DF5FF` / `#0096B4`	Swaps	Swap buttons, the ⇄ mark, match badges, active nav glow. Text on cyan is `#00151A`. Cyan text on light uses `#006B80`.
Solar Gold	`#FFC857` / `#E0A526`	Bids, Pro & coins	Bid bars, PRO badges, Create button, Swap Coins. Text on gold is `#1A1000`. Gold text on light uses `#8A5A00`.
Electric Violet	`#8B5CF6` / `#6D3CE0`	Atmosphere	Glows, gradients, the logo mark. Never for body text.
Hot Pink	`#FF4FD8` / `#D428A8`	Circle & alerts	Women's Circle, unread dots, mystery boxes.
Live Red	`#FF3B6B` / `#E0234F`	Live	LIVE pills, last 5 minutes of a countdown, end-call button.
Steel	`#9AA8C7` / `#565C75`	Secondary text	8:1 on Deep Space ✓.

COLOUR RULE

Gold means money and coins, cyan means swap. Never use gold on a swap action or cyan on a bid action.

Futuristic style rules V4

- **Panels:** blue-tinted glass (6% dark, 52% light), 22 px blur, a 1 px cyan-tinted border and a faint outer glow. Panels brighten their border on hover.
- **Background:** violet, cyan and pink glows, a perspective grid that scrolls towards the viewer, and a very faint scan-line texture.
- **Glow:** neon glow on the active nav item (with a cyan-to-violet bar), primary buttons, LIVE pills, meters and coin chips.
- **Gradient text:** the Swap wordmark and page headings use an ink-to-cyan-to-violet gradient. Headings are uppercase with wide spacing.
- **Logo mark:** a conic cyan-violet-pink gradient tile that slowly shifts hue.
- **Motion:** every animation stops when the device asks for reduced motion.
- **Legibility:** labels on photos and covers sit on a dark frosted chip. Never put text on a glow or the grid.
- **Fallback:** if blur is unsupported, panels become solid Deep Space or the light background.

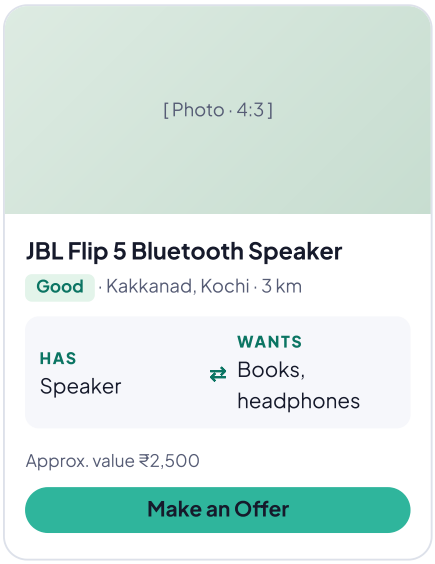
Typography CHANGED IN V5

Use	Font	Why
Everything V5	Plus Jakarta Sans 400–800	One family for headings, body, prices and numbers on the app, website and Control Center. Headings use 800 with tight tracking. Section titles are uppercase with wide tracking.

Regional (later)	Noto Sans Malayalam / Devanagari	For localisation. Pair them with Plus Jakarta Sans sizes.

Mobile scale: H1 32/36 · H2 22/28 (uppercase, +6% tracking) · H3 18/24 · Body 15–16/24 · Small 13/18. Form fields stay at 16 px or above, so iOS doesn't zoom in.

The signature component: Have/Want listing card



Card rules

1. **Hierarchy:** photo → title → condition and distance → **Has ⇄ Wants** row → value → button.
2. The **Wants** row is the visual hero: tinted panel, bold labels. If "open to offers" is on, show "Open to offers".
3. **Approx. value** is optional, 11–12 px, Mist Grey, never bold, never larger than the Wants text. Hide it if empty.
4. **Match badge:** if the viewer owns an item in the Wants list, show a teal "Wants your {item}!" badge on the photo. This is the most persuasive element in the product.
5. Show the area, not the exact address. Round distance to whole km.
6. One button only. Tapping the card opens the detail page.

UX rules

- **Listing in under 2 minutes:** camera first, auto-suggest the category from the title, one screen, and save drafts automatically.
- **Let people browse before sign-up**. Ask for login only at List / Offer / Chat.
- **Phone OTP sign-up** as the default. Google sign-in second.
- **One primary button per screen.**
- **Touch targets** ≥ 44 × 44 px. Sticky "Make an Offer" on listing pages on mobile.
- **Designed for low bandwidth:** image placeholders, skeleton loaders and a usable page within 3 s on 4G.
- **Share to WhatsApp** on every listing and every match. This is the main growth loop in India.
- **Accessibility:** alt text on listing photos (prompt the lister), visible focus states, labels on all form fields, and never use colour alone to show meaning.
- **Illustrations** over stock photos for concept sections. Real listing photos for marketplace sections.

PART 13

Legal, policy & launch checklist

This checklist is not legal advice. It lists what Indian counsel should review before the site goes live. v1 noted that legal review is needed. This makes it concrete.

Pages that must exist at launch

Page	Must cover
Terms of Use	Swap's role as an intermediary, member obligations, prohibited conduct, dispute process, liability limits, account suspension, governing law and jurisdiction.
Privacy Policy	DPDP Act 2023: what data is collected (phone, location, photos, chats), purpose, consent and withdrawal, retention, Data Protection Officer or contact, and user rights (access, correction, erasure).
Prohibited Items	The full list (summary in the Safety Centre) plus what happens to violating listings.
Community Guidelines	Honest listings, respectful chat, no-show policy, rating integrity, and the consequences ladder (warning → restriction → ban).
Grievance Officer	Name, contact and response timelines under the IT (Intermediary Guidelines) Rules 2021 and, if applicable, the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules 2020.
Auction Rules NEW	Binding bids, anti-sniping, auto-bid, shill-bidding ban, strikes, verification, escrow timelines, disputes, fees and refunds.
Pro Terms & Refunds NEW	Subscription price, trial, renewal, cancellation, GST, and refunds under the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules.
Cookie notice	Consent banner for analytics and marketing cookies.
Draw & Giveaway Rules V4	Free entry only, 18+, how winners are picked and announced, prize delivery, host obligations, no purchase or coins to enter (Part 19).
Swap Coins Terms V4	How coins are earned and used, no cash value, can't be bought, sold or transferred for money, expiry, misuse and clawback (Part 17).
Advertising Policy V4	Ad review, "Sponsored" labels, prohibited ad categories, ASCI code, no ads to under-18s (Part 21).
Account Deletion & Data Retention V5	30-day grace period, what is erased, what the law requires us to keep (auction, escrow and tax records, without a name), and how to cancel.
ID Verification Notice V5	Aadhaar is optional; which IDs are accepted; consent; only the last 4 digits and the result are stored; the provider used.
Swap Exclusive Brand Terms V5	Authenticity, one-of-one promise, GST invoices, returns that don't match the certificate, counterfeit penalties, the 8% fee.
Parental Consent V4	How 15–17-year-olds' parents or guardians give verifiable consent under the DPDP Act, and what teen accounts can do (Part 15).

PAYMENTS & AUCTIONS: EXTRA COMPLIANCE (PHASE 2)

- **Never hold buyers' money yourself.** Use an RBI-authorised payment aggregator with an escrow or nodal-account product to run SwapSafe.
- **Tax:** GST on the Pro subscription and the success fee. As an e-commerce operator, you may also need to collect TCS under GST and deduct TDS under the Income-tax Act on sellers' payouts. Confirm the current rates with a CA.
- **Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules 2020:** show seller details, the total price and the refund policy, and run the grievance process for auction buyers too.
- **Know your seller:** Pro sellers need verified ID and bank details (PAN above set limits) before their first payout.
- **Keep auctions chance-free:** no paid entries and no "mystery" lots in auctions. Mystery boxes exist only as swaps with a declared minimum value (Part 18), so nothing could be read as gambling.

Claims gate: say it only when it's true

Claim in copy	Publish only when…
"Free to join" / "Is it free? Yes"	The pricing policy is final and documented.
"Verified members", ✓ badge	A verification process exists (e.g. phone + ID) and is described.
Ratings and reviews	The two-way rating system is live.
"Near you", distance filters	Location services work and protect privacy (area only).
"Matches for me", match badge	Matching logic is built and tested.
"✓ Verified item"	A team actually checks documents, IMEI and photos for every auction.
"SwapSafe escrow", "your money is held safely"	A licensed payment partner holds the funds, and the release and dispute flow is live.
Trust score	Every input is real and the formula is published in Help.
Pro price, trial, "5% only when it sells"	Pricing is final and the Pro Terms page is live.
"We review reports within {X} hours"	A moderation team or owner and an SLA are in place.
Counter-offers ("Suggest another item")	The feature exists. Otherwise remove the link.
Delivery, ValueMatch, Skills	Launched. Until then, label them "Coming soon" or remove them.
"150 coins with Circle members", Circle badge V4	Selfie + ID verification is live, the ID image is deleted after checking, and the badge is opt-in.
"Swap Coins as a digital currency" V4	**Never**, until regulators allow it. Keep it to "Coming in the future. Stay tuned." with no dates, returns or exchange rates.
"Free to enter", draw winners V4	Entry truly needs no payment, purchase or coins, and winners are picked by an auditable random draw.
"{n} items near you", member counts	The numbers are real and live. Never inflate or invent them.
"Listing takes 2 minutes", "4+ photos get more offers"	Measured in your own data.

Pre-launch checklist

Content

- ☐ Founder decisions made: launch mode and auction timing (cash in swaps and age decided in v4)
- ☐ Placeholders **{…}** replaced site-wide
- ☐ Team section with real photos on the About page
- ☐ Example listings labelled “Example”
- ☐ Retired slogans removed; CTA labels match Part 02
- ☐ Proofread in Indian English

Legal

- ☐ All six legal pages reviewed by counsel
- ☐ Grievance Officer appointed and published
- ☐ Date of birth at sign-up: 15+ to join, verifiable parental consent for 15–17, 18+ gates on auctions, plans, draws and studio
- ☐ Consent logs for marketing; SMS DLT templates registered
- ☐ Trademark search and filing for “Swap” (Class 35); the plain word may need a distinctive mark, e.g. the Swap logo or “Swap by HPY”

Product & trust

- ☐ Auctions (phase 2): payment partner live, escrow tested, verification team trained
- ☐ Report flow tested end to end, with a named moderator on duty
- ☐ Prohibited-keyword filter on listings
- ☐ Chat scam-word warning is live
- ☐ 300+ seed listings in the launch city (Mode A)
- ☐ All empty states and errors use Part 10 copy
- ☐ v4: teen gates tested (auctions, plans, draws, studio, calls, no ads)
- ☐ v4: calls run on a vetted WebRTC provider, with in-call report and block
- ☐ v4: video uploads limited to 2:00 and run through moderation
- ☐ v5: SMS provider with TRAI DLT templates for login codes; email provider for email codes
- ☐ v5: Google client ID and Apple Services ID set on the server
- ☐ v5: DigiLocker / UIDAI offline e-KYC partner, plus passport, licence and voter ID checks
- ☐ v5: GSTIN and trademark checks for Swap Exclusive brands
- ☐ v5: planting, food-relief and clean-up partners signed, with proof for every batch
- ☐ v5: name decided (Swap or swapo) and trademark search done

SEO & analytics

- ☐ Titles, metas and H1s match Part 11
- ☐ Schema validated in Rich Results Test
- ☐ Search Console and sitemap.xml submitted
- ☐ Funnel events tracked: visit → sign-up → first listing → first offer → first completed exchange
- ☐ North-star metrics agreed: **completed swaps per week** and, once auctions launch, **auctions sold per week**

PART 14

Brand copy kit

Ready-to-paste descriptions at every length, for app stores, press, social and partners.

Descriptions	BY LENGTH
ONE-LINER	Swap is India's social marketplace for swapping, with auctions for verified items.
25 WORDS	Swap lets people across India swap what they no longer use for what they want. Earn Swap Coins for every 5-star swap. Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange.
50 WORDS	Swap is an exchange marketplace for India. List something you don't use, say what you'd like in return, and find people nearby who have it. Every listing shows what the owner has and wants, so fair, money-free swaps are easy to find. Every 5-star swap earns Swap Coins, and Pro members can auction verified items, with payment held in escrow. Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange.
BRAND STORY	**Everything has value.** Every home has them: the old phone, the unused cycle, the book you've already read. And somewhere nearby, someone is about to buy exactly those things new. What if you could just exchange? That's Swap, a marketplace built on a simple belief: value doesn't need a price tag. List what you have, find what you want, and agree on a swap that works for both of you. Fewer things wasted. More things used. And two people who both walk away happy. **Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange.**

Social & app store	CHANNEL COPY
INSTAGRAM BIO	Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange. ⇄ India's first exchange marketplace, from Kochi Swap what you don't use for what you want List your first item
X / LINKEDIN BIO	India's social marketplace for swapping. Swap what you don't use for what you want, or bid on verified items from Pro sellers.
APP TITLE (30)	Swap
APP SUBTITLE (30)	Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Exchange.
WHATSAPP SHARE	I'm exchanging my {item} on Swap. Want it? Here's what I'm looking for: {wants}. {link}
REFERRAL	Got stuff you don't use? Join me on Swap and swap it for something you want. {link}

Campaign starter lines	USE WITH THE TAGLINE
STUDENTS	Last semester's books ⇄ This semester's headphones.

YOUNG PROS	New city, new flat, old stuff. Exchange it.
FAMILIES	Kids outgrow toys. Toys don't have to go to waste.
EVERYONE	Your drawer is full of currency.
PRO SELLERS NEW	Verified. Bid on. Sold. Your gear deserves an auction.
LIVE DROPS NEW	Ten minutes. One watch. Fastest fingers win.

NEXT STEPS

1. Founders confirm the two open decisions on page 2 (launch mode and auction timing).
2. Design: homepage (Part 05), Have/Want card (Part 12), listing flow and offer flow (Part 10), mobile first.
3. Counsel reviews the Part 13 legal set while design is in progress.
4. Launch Mode B in one city, seed listings, then switch to Mode A.
5. Phase 2: sign a payment partner, train the verification team, then open Pro auctions (Part 08).
6. Phase 3: switch on Swap Coins, Women's Circle, the Pro Plus studio, calls and Swap Ads (Parts 16–21), each after its legal page is live.

PART 15 · NEW IN V4

Ownership, editions & age rules

One codebase builds two editions. The website behaves like LinkedIn: the same social feed, plus the business side of Swap.

Ownership

OWNER

HPY initiative

Swap is a HPY initiative.

OWNER, HPY

Hiranya Mohandas

HPY is owned by Hiranya Mohandas.

ALIGNED WITH SWAP

Sreejith Maheswar · Sankar R

App vs website

Feature	App	Website
Feed, stories, swipe, auctions, messages, profile, coins, draws, events, groups, Create	✓	✓
Ads in the feed, stories, side rail and auctions (never for teens)	✓	✓
Ads Manager (create and run campaigns)	— links to web	✓
About Swap with ownership (HPY, Hiranya Mohandas, Sreejith Maheswar, Sankar R)	— links to web	✓

BUILD NOTE

Set `EDITION` to `"app"` or `"web"`. Web-only items carry a `webonly` class. In the app, those routes show a card: “This is on the Swap website” with a link.

Age rules

Who	Can	Can't
Teen account (15–17)	Browse, like, comment, follow, chat; offer swaps and ask for items; join groups and events; earn Swap Coins; join Women's Circle	**See auctions** (hidden everywhere) · Pro and Pro Plus · draws, giveaways, challenges, mystery boxes · creator studio · calls. **Sees no ads.**
18–22 V5	Everything their plan includes, and **watch** every auction, follow bids and save auctions	Bid, buy or sell by auction, including Swap Exclusive
23+ V5	Everything their plan includes, including bidding, buying and selling by auction	—
Under 15	Can't sign up.	

AGE IS A SIGN-UP RULE, NOT A SWITCH

Age comes from the verified date of birth at sign-up. There is no age toggle anywhere in the product. Teen tips appear in chat: “Meet only in busy public places, and take a parent or guardian with you.”

DPDP ACT 2023

Under-18 accounts need verifiable parental consent, no behavioural tracking and no targeted ads. Contracts with minors are void under the Indian Contract Act 1872, which is why every money feature is 18+.

18+ gate	MODAL COPY
TITLE	18+ only
TEEN CAN	Browse, like, comment, follow and chat · Offer swaps and ask for items · Join groups and events · Watch live auctions
18+ ONLY	Seeing auctions · Pro and Pro Plus plans · Draws, giveaways and challenges
23+ GATE V5	**Bidding opens at 23.** Members 18–22 can watch every auction live and follow the bids. Bidding, buying and selling by auction open at 23.

PART 16 · NEW IN V4

Three plans: Free, Pro, Pro Plus

Free lets you explore and take part. Pro lets you bid and sell a little. Pro Plus unlocks everything. Paid plans are 18+.

	Free · ₹0	Pro · ₹149/mo	Pro Plus · ₹399/mo
Browse, like, comment, follow, chat, swaps, swipe	✓	✓	✓
Events, groups, Swap Coins, Women's Circle	✓	✓	✓
Watch auctions	✓	✓	✓
Bid on auctions	—	✓	✓
Sell by auction	—	3 / month	Unlimited
Auction formats	—	Classic, Reserve, Bid or Buy Now	All 7, incl. Live drop, Sealed, Price drop, Swap or Bid
Auto-bid, seller analytics, boosted posts, priority verification	—	—	✓
Creator studio: draws, giveaways, challenges, mystery boxes, 2-min videos	—	—	✓
Voice and video calls	—	—	✓
Fee when an item sells	—	5%	3%

Upgrade gates	COPY
PRO GATE	**This needs Pro.** Swapping is free forever. Selling by auction needs Pro, with your item verified first.
PRO LIMIT	Pro includes 3 auctions a month, and you've used them all. Pro Plus is unlimited.
STUDIO GATE	**This needs Pro Plus.** The full creator studio is part of Pro Plus: auctions, free lucky draws, giveaways, challenges, mystery boxes and videos up to 2 minutes.
CALLS GATE	**This needs Pro Plus.** Voice and video calls with your swap partners are part of Pro Plus.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

All prices are example pricing. GST applies. Publish Pro Terms & Refunds before taking any payment. Pro membership must never raise the trust score.

PART 17 · NEW IN V4

Swap Coins & Women's Circle

Swap Coins reward good exchanges, and replace cash when a swap isn't even.

Rule	Detail
Earn	Every swap rated ★★★★★ earns **100 coins**.
Unlock at 1,000	With 1,000 coins or more, members can add coins to swap offers.
⇄ Swap with coins	Have a camera but want a motorbike accessory worth more? Offer the camera plus coins, or coins on their own if you have enough. The offer form shows a coins field once unlocked.
Future	Show only: "Swap Coins as a digital currency. Stay tuned." No dates, no details.
Where coins show	Top bar pill (mobile), nav rail chip, the Coins page and a gold coin card on your own profile with an unlock meter.

Women's Circle

When two verified women or girls finish a swap rated ★★★★★, both get **+50 bonus coins**: 150 per swap instead of 100.

- **Joining:** from the Coins page. A quick selfie check matched to ID. The ID image is deleted after checking.
- **Badge:** "♀ Women's Circle" on the profile, opt-in. Chats with another member show "♀ Circle swap · +50 bonus coins".
- **Teens:** girls aged 15–17 can join; coins have no cash value, so no money is involved.

Coins copy	FINAL
EARNED TOAST	★★★★★ swap with {name}. +100 / +150 (Circle bonus)
PROFILE CARD	Swap Coins {balance} · Unlocked for deals / {n} to unlock · +100 per 5-star swap →
LEGAL LINE	Swap Coins are rewards inside Swap. They have no cash value and can't be bought or sold.

KEEP COINS OUT OF REGULATED TERRITORY

Never sell coins, pay them out, let them be traded for money, or promise value growth. That keeps them a loyalty reward rather than a prepaid payment instrument (RBI PPI rules) or a crypto-asset. Get legal advice before any "digital currency" step.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

A women-only bonus is a promotional benefit. Counsel should confirm the eligibility wording and verification method, and the policy for non-binary members.

PART 18 · NEW IN V4

Pro Plus creator studio & calls

The Create button opens one page. Everyone gets the swap tools; Pro Plus members (18+) get the studio.

Studio tool	What the host sets	Rules
Auction	The Part 08 auction flow	Verified items only
Lucky draw	Prize, category, winners (1–10), free ways to enter (follow, comment, share), ends in 1/3/7 days	Free entry only. Swap picks winners at random and shows them on the post.
Giveaway	Item, category, how the winner is picked (random, best reason why, first to ask), end	Free entry only
Challenge	Title, task, prize, judged by (community votes or host), category, end	Won by skill or effort, never chance
Mystery box	Theme, category, items inside, **minimum value** (₹200+), boxes available, what it's swapped for	Swapped for items, never sold. Host confirms contents are legal and worth the minimum. Swap may check the box.
Video	Video file, title, category	Up to **2:00**. Longer files are refused: "That video is 2:10. Videos can be up to 2:00."

Voice and video calls

- and buttons in every chat header. Pro Plus and 18+.
- Ringing → connected timer · mute · camera on/off (video) · speaker (voice) · end.
- A call note is added to the chat: "Voice call · 0:42" or "Cancelled".
- Calls stay inside Swap; phone numbers are never shared. Report and block are available in the call.

BUILD NOTE

Real calls need a WebRTC provider with TURN servers, a push service for ringing, and storage of call metadata only (no recordings). The current build shows the call interface without sending audio or video.

PART 19 · NEW IN V4

Draws, giveaways & the no-lottery rule

A request to run lottery-style selling was reviewed and declined. Swap uses free-entry alternatives that create the same excitement legally.

WHY NO PAID LOTTERIES

Under the Lotteries (Regulation) Act 1998 only state governments may organise lotteries (Kerala runs its own state lottery); a private platform cannot. Paid entry for a prize by chance can also fall under the Prize Chits and Money Circulation Schemes (Banning) Act 1978 and Kerala gaming law. So: **no ticket sales, no "pay ₹X for a chance", no coins to enter.**

Draws page section	How it works
Weekly free draw	Entries come from free actions: list an item, complete a swap, invite a friend, daily check-in. Random winner, shown publicly.
Business giveaways	Local businesses sponsor prizes for free entry. Marked as sponsored.
Skill quiz	Answer a question correctly to win. Skill, not chance.
Mystery box swaps	Swap an item for a sealed themed box with a guaranteed minimum value.

Every draw links to the Draw & Giveaway Rules page. All of it is 18+.

PART 20 · NEW IN V4

Community: events, groups, Bike & Car

Events

Swap meets, fairs and live auctions, online or in person. Members can create an event, RSVP and see attendees. Live auction events link straight to the auction.

Groups

Topic communities with their own feed, listings from the matching category and linked events. Members can create a group. Examples: Plant Swap Kochi, Kochi Riders Swap.

New category: Bike & Car

Allowed	Not allowed at launch
Helmets (ISI marked), riding jackets and gloves, dash cams, phone mounts, tank bags, car accessories, tools, spare parts with proof of ownership	Vehicles themselves (need RC transfer, insurance and RTO checks), number plates, airbags, anything that defeats emissions or safety systems

Category order: All · Electronics · Books · Sports · Home · Fashion · Hobbies · Kids · Bike & Car. Icon:.

PART 21 · NEW IN V4

Swap Ads platform

Local businesses advertise to people while they swap, bid and browse. Every ad is reviewed and labelled “Sponsored”.

Placement	Where	Example CPM
Feed	A card between posts	₹80
Story	A full-screen story in the stories row	₹120
Side rail	Right column on the website	₹60
Auction	Inside the Auction House	₹150

- **Ads Manager (website only):** create a campaign (business, headline, image, call to action, placement, budget, area), pause, resume or delete, and see impressions and clicks.
- **Never shown to teen accounts.** No targeting by sensitive data.
- Ads follow the ASCI Code; claims need evidence. No ads for gambling, alcohol, tobacco, crypto or prohibited items.

CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

CPMs are examples. Ad payments need GST invoices, and ad revenue must stay separate from SwapSafe escrow.

PART 22 · NEW IN V4

Profile motion

4-second motion profile

Element	Behaviour
Profile picture	Moves gently inside a spinning neon ring (cyan → violet → pink → gold) on a 4-second loop.
Cover	Flowing gradient, floating swap icons and a light sweep, all on a 4-second loop. Labelled "▶ 4s motion".
Own uploads	Edit buttons (camera icon) on your own profile. A video plays only its first 4 seconds, on repeat, muted. A photo gets a slow 4-second zoom. Max 25 MB.
Reduced motion	All loops stop and videos pause when the device asks for reduced motion.

BUILD NOTE

Moderate uploaded profile clips the same way as listing photos. Keep the first frame meaningful, since it's what shows when motion is off.

SWAP · A HPY INITIATIVE

Don't Buy. Don't Sell. Just Exchange. India's first exchange marketplace from God's Own Country. Made with ❤ in Kochi.

PART 23 · NEW IN V5

Accounts: sign up, log in, leave

The app and website open on one Log in / Sign up screen with the logo and tagline. Visitors can also explore a demo account without signing up.

Sign up

Field	Rule
Full name	Required. Must match the ID if the member verifies one later.
Username	3–30 letters, numbers, dots or underscores. Availability is checked as you type.
Mobile number	Required. Indian number (+91), verified with a 6-digit code before the account is created. One account per number.
Email	Optional (Gmail works). Verified later with a code for +10 trust. Google and Apple emails count as verified.
Date of birth	15+ to join. The form explains the member's age group as they type (15–17, 18–22, 23+).
Parent or guardian	Required for 15–17. They confirm the account (DPDP Act 2023).
Password	At least 8 characters. Not needed when signing up with Google or Apple.
Verify your ID (optional)	Ticked by default. Opens the ID check straight after sign-up (Part 24).

Log in

- **Continue with Google** or **Continue with Apple**. A new Google or Apple account finishes sign-up with a username and mobile number. One whose verified email matches an existing account is linked to it.
- **Mobile number:** a 6-digit code by SMS.
- **Username:** username, mobile or email, plus password. “Forgot your password?” offers a code instead.
- **Code rules:** valid for 10 minutes; locked after 5 wrong tries; a new code after 30 seconds.

Deactivate or delete

	Deactivate	Delete
What happens	Profile, listings and posts are hidden. Coins, swaps and history are kept.	The account is deleted after a 30-day grace period and hidden in the meantime.
Coming back	Log in any time to reactivate.	Logging in during the 30 days cancels the deletion.
Erased	—	Profile, photos, listings, messages, boards, Swap Coins, sign-in details, ID result.
Kept by law	—	Auction sales, escrow payments and tax invoices, without the member's name.
Confirm with	Password (if set), optional reason	Password (if set) and typing DELETE

BLOCKED WHILE OPEN

Neither is allowed while the member has a live auction, an escrow payment, or a swap they've agreed but not completed. The settings page lists what to finish first.

Account copy	FINAL
DEACTIVATED	Your account @{handle} is deactivated. Log in any time to reactivate it.
DELETING	@{handle} will be deleted on {date}. Log in before then to cancel.
WELCOME BACK	Welcome back. Your account is active again. / Welcome back. We've cancelled your account deletion.

PART 24 · NEW IN V5

Trust score, ID checks & welcome bonus

Starting trust: 50

Verified	Points
Mobile number (needed to sign up)	20
Email (6-digit code)	10
ID: Aadhaar, passport, driving licence or voter ID	20
All three	**50**

Swaps, ratings and reliability raise trust towards 100 (Part 07). Paying for a plan never adds trust.

ID verification

- **Options:** Aadhaar via DigiLocker (recommended), Aadhaar offline e-KYC from UIDAI, passport, driving licence or voter ID.
- **Aadhaar happens on DigiLocker or UIDAI,** not on Swap's form. Swap receives the result.
- **Stored:** the method, the last 4 digits and a keyed hash of the provider's reference, so one ID can't verify two accounts. The name and date of birth must match the account.
- **Shown:** "Aadhaar via DigiLocker ending 4321 ✓" in settings, and a verified tick on the profile.

AADHAAR MUST STAY OPTIONAL

Since the Supreme Court's 2018 Puttaswamy judgment and under the Aadhaar Act 2016, a private service can't require Aadhaar or store full Aadhaar numbers. Every listed ID earns the same 20 trust points, and the server rejects a full 12-digit number.

Welcome bonus: 1,000 Swap Coins

Paid once, when all 9 profile items are done: name, username, mobile, email, ID, date of birth, city or area, bio and photo. A "Finish your profile" card with a progress bar sits on the feed and profile until it's claimed. 1,000 coins also unlocks coin deals.

WATCH FOR ABUSE

Free coins attract duplicate accounts. One mobile, one email and one ID per account limit this. Review coin patterns in the Control Center ledger.

PART 25 · NEW IN V5

Swap Exclusive: brand auctions

Verified brands release single pieces, made once and never repeated, as executive auctions.

Element	Rule
Verified brand page	The brand applies on the website with its registered name, GSTIN, trademark or authorisation, and website. Staff check them and verify or reject the brand with a reason. The page shows "◆ Verified brand", "Sold by {registered name} · GSTIN · city", live drops, past sales and returns.
One of one	Each piece gets edition "1 of 1" and a certificate number (e.g. SWX-KKC-0042). Cash auctions only; no swap-or-bid.
Verified bidders	23+, Pro or Pro Plus, and a one-time ID + PAN check before the first bid.
Fee	8% when a piece sells (example pricing). The brand is paid through SwapSafe after the buyer confirms, with a GST invoice from the brand.
Suspension	Suspending a brand cancels its live drops.
Upcoming drops	Listed with "Remind me", so members are alerted 15 minutes before.

PART 26 · NEW IN V5

Discover pins, boards & reels

Discover (Pinterest style)

- Explore becomes **Discover**: a masonry wall of pins in varied heights, 4 columns on desktop and 2 on phones. The feed also has a **Discover** tab.
- Each pin shows the item, what the owner wants (or the live price and countdown for auctions) and who posted it.
- **Save** puts a pin on a board (Wishlist, Bike & ride gear, Room makeover, or a new board). Boards are a tab on your own profile, shown as photo collages.

Reels

- A full-screen vertical feed: swipe on phones, scroll or use the arrow keys on desktop, and tap to pause. Reels is in the bottom bar.
- **Auction reels** show the live price and countdown with **Bid now**, or **Watch live** for members under 23. **Swap reels** show Has ⇄ Wants with **Offer a swap**. Studio videos play as reels.
- Each reel has like, comment, share and save. A “Reels for you” strip sits on the home feed.
- Under-18s don't see auction reels.

PART 27 · NEW IN V5

Social add-ons

Status	Add-ons
Live	Share anywhere (WhatsApp, Instagram Stories, Facebook, X, copy link) · Story templates (9:16 with Has ⇄ Wants and a QR code)
Beta	AI swap assistant · Co-hosted live shopping (Pro Plus, 18+)
Coming soon	Instagram & Facebook cross-post · Import from Instagram · WhatsApp catalogue sync · Export to Shorts & Reels · AR preview · Group swaps · Creator collabs (18+, labelled as paid) · Malayalam voice search

PROMISE

Connected accounts only post what the member chooses, and they can disconnect any time. Cross-posting needs Meta and Google developer approval.

PART 28 · NEW IN V5

Swap Green

Pledge	How it's delivered
1 completed swap = 1 tree	Native trees planted in batches each monsoon with planting partners, geo-tagged and checked again at 6 months.
Every 10,000 swaps = 10,000 meals	Funded through a registered food-relief partner for families facing hunger, in India and abroad. Receipts are published.
Every 10,000 swaps = 1 clean-up drive	Beaches, lakes and canals in Kerala first. Anyone can join, and the weight collected is published.

The app shows a Swap Green page (counters, milestones, clean-up events, planting log, “How we count”), a feed strip, a website side box and trees on profiles. Each completed swap shows “A tree will be planted for your swap”.

GREEN CLAIMS MUST BE PROVABLE (ASCI)

Always separate **pledged** from **planted / funded**, and label CO_2e and landfill figures as estimates (about 12 kg CO_2e and 2.5 kg per swap). In the Control Center, a batch counts as delivered only with a partner, place, date and proof link.

BUDGET

Rough planning numbers to confirm with partners: ₹50–150 per tree planted and cared for; ₹3–5 lakh per 10,000 meals.

PART 29 · NEW IN V5

Brand identity: logo, type, icons

Logo



- Used in every header: the app and website side menu, the phone top bar, the login screen and the Control Center.
- It's applied as a shape that takes the theme colour: white-to-violet on dark, and the purple gradient `#9A4DFF → #4A00F5` on light.
- Leave clear space around it at least the height of the "s". Never stretch it, recolour it outside these two treatments, or put it on a busy photo.

> **BEFORE LAUNCH**
> The wordmark reads "swapo" with a © mark. Confirm the name, and get the artwork's rights in writing if a designer or design site made it.

Type

Plus Jakarta Sans on every surface, including this playbook.

Icons, not emojis

- Buttons, headings, menus, labels and messages use words or clean line icons, never decorative emojis.
- Swap Coins use a small gold coin shape.
- Kept as symbols: ⇄ (swap), ◆ (Exclusive), ★ (ratings), ✓ (verified), ♀ (Women's Circle) and the ♥ in "Made with ♥ in Kochi".
- Emojis appear only as stand-ins for product photos until members upload real ones.

PART 30 · NEW IN V5

Backend & Control Center

One Node.js server provides the REST API at `/api` and the staff Control Center at `/admin`, with SQLite storage and end-to-end tests. Every rule in this playbook is enforced on the server, not only in the app.

Roles

Moderators handle trust and safety. **Admins** also control plans, roles, coins and settings. Every staff action goes to the audit log.

Control Center sections

Section	What staff do
Dashboard	What needs action (reports, auctions to verify, ads, Circle, teen consent, flagged messages, brands, bidder ID checks), plus live platform numbers
Users	Verify, suspend, confirm guardian consent, approve Circle and bidder ID; admins change plans, roles, trust and coins. Shows mobile, email and ID status, and accounts that are deactivated or being deleted.
Reports	Dismiss, warn, remove the item or suspend the owner; scam-word messages
Auctions	Verification queue, cancel, escrow status
Brands & bidders	Verify, reject or suspend Swap Exclusive brands; approve bidder ID checks
Studio & draws	Pick winners with a secure random draw; remove posts
Ads · Content · Coins & Circle · Calls	Approve ads, remove content, coin ledger and Circle queue, call records
Swap Green	Pledged vs delivered; record batches with proof
Settings	Feature switches, maintenance mode, prices, fees, coin rules (including the welcome bonus), trust points, ages (join 15, see auctions 18, bid 23, deletion grace 30 days), ad prices, Exclusive fee, categories
Audit log	Every staff action and automatic event

Providers to connect before launch

- Payment gateway for plans; RBI-authorised aggregator for SwapSafe escrow
- SMS provider (TRAI DLT) and an email provider for codes
- Google client ID and Apple Services ID
- DigiLocker / e-KYC partner and document checks
- WebRTC provider for calls
- Object storage and moderation for photos and videos
- GST and trademark verification for brands
- HTTPS hosting, daily backups, and PostgreSQL when running more than one server

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